Growing Together

An original childcare-center learning curriculum from birth through age six. The final pathway includes 5- and 6-year-olds, through 83 months.

A whole-child, play-based organization

Warm relationships and responsive care are the foundation. Infants learn through everyday interaction, safe movement and care. Toddlers explore concrete materials and familiar routines. Older children combine sustained play and inquiry with meaningful explicit teaching. Children can participate through movement, gesture, speech, signs, augmentative communication, observation and adapted action.

What is included

Seven age pathways; seven connected learning areas; 98 original activity plans; twelve inquiry connections organized into 48 flexible planning slots; daily flow examples; planning and observation forms; and a self-contained browser tool. Four additional weeks of a 52-week calendar remain available for closures, transitions, repetition or local priorities.

Research status — read before implementation

The request was to use popular U.S. curricula as a research starting point. Live search and all ten reference requests were blocked by the environment’s network proxy, including public government, professional and publisher sites. A current nationwide popularity ranking and current primary-source review were not verified. This is an original professional draft based on general established early-childhood knowledge, not a completed live literature review.

The Creative Curriculum, HighScope and Frog Street are recognizable curriculum families for later comparison. No market-share numbers, ranking, endorsement or claim that this resource reproduces any of them is made.

Edition 1.0 · Prepared for review on 2026-10-17 · Local standards, health procedures, individualized plans and trained staff review remain part of implementation.

Why this teaching approach

The curriculum uses a play-based, whole-child structure because it can organize a full childcare day across infancy, toddlerhood, preschool and the kindergarten years. Responsive interaction, intentional teaching and child-led inquiry are complementary teaching moves. No one move is suitable for every purpose or age.

Reference family / approach	Broad organizing idea	How this original draft uses the idea
The Creative Curriculum	Comprehensive whole-child curriculum family. Current product details were not retrieved.	Keep learning areas, routines, environment and assessment connected without copying commercial lessons.
HighScope	Active participatory learning and intentional adult support. Current source not retrieved.	Offer choice, meaningful action and reflection at an accessible level.
Frog Street	Recognizable early-childhood curriculum family. Current source not retrieved.	Use a coherent center-wide organization while retaining child/family responsiveness.
Inquiry / project learning	Questions can develop through revisiting materials, evidence and representation.	Use flexible inquiry connections for older children; do not impose projects on infants.
Responsive, developmentally appropriate teaching	Individual, family and contextual knowledge inform interaction. Reference routes not retrieved.	Adjust to cues, strengths, access, home languages and care needs rather than age-only tasks.

These are descriptive comparisons, not a popularity table or a verified product evaluation. The resource is original and is not licensed, affiliated with or endorsed by the named programs. A later source-based review should compare age coverage, evidence, training, family access, adaptations, cost and observation methods before a center purchases a commercial curriculum.

The teaching commitments

Connect before directing

Know the child and the family. Learn the names, languages, communication forms, comfort preferences and supports that make participation possible. An adult’s availability and predictable response are learning conditions, not rewards.

Protect care, movement and sustained play

Needed feeding, rest, hygiene, comfort and health care are never delayed to finish an activity. Infants follow individual cues and plans. For older children, plan long enough for meaningful self-chosen play, outdoor movement and creative work alongside useful short teaching invitations.

Teach intentionally without taking over

Choose an action that fits the purpose: wait, describe, demonstrate, offer vocabulary, model a strategy, ask a genuine question, add a useful material or step back. Explicit instruction in a needed tool can sit inside play and projects. Repeated testing, copying and worksheets are not the organizing core.

Let evidence change the plan

A good activity may be declined. Record what actually happened and adapt the invitation, materials, timing or adult support. Repetition of familiar work is productive. A child’s choice to watch or communicate differently is participation, not evidence of inability.

Avoid age-only expectations

Pathways organize possible environments and experiences. They are not milestone checklists, readiness gates or requirements to complete every activity. Co-regulation and adapted access remain legitimate supports at every age.

Seven connected learning areas

Area	Purpose	Illustrative framework connection
Relationships & regulation	Warm relationships, co-regulation, belonging, turn taking and solving social problems.	Social and Emotional Development; Approaches to Learning
Communication & early literacy	Back-and-forth communication, home languages, stories, sound awareness, reading and purposeful writing.	Language and Communication / Language and Literacy; Approaches to Learning
Movement & self-care	Safe movement, coordination, body awareness, participation in daily care and growing practical independence.	Perceptual, Motor, and Physical Development
Thinking & mathematics	Attention, memory, comparison, spatial thinking, number relationships and flexible problem solving.	Cognition / Mathematics Development; Approaches to Learning
Science & inquiry	Close observation, questions, cause and effect, living things and testing ideas safely.	Cognition / Scientific Reasoning; Approaches to Learning
Creative expression	Original choices through art, music, movement, construction and representation.	Integrated expression across domains; Approaches to Learning
Community & belonging	Family identity, home cultures, access, respectful relationships and care for shared places.	Social and Emotional Development; Language and Communication

Attention, interest, persistence, flexibility, help seeking and accessible communication cut across every area. Art and community learning are integrated experiences, not optional rewards after academic work.

The connection column is an author-created organizational crosswalk using familiar Head Start ELOF domain terms. The framework could not be retrieved in this session; no code-by-code, current-edition or official alignment is claimed. ELOF is a birth-to-five reference, and the kindergarten bridge needs separate local/school review.

Prepare a usable environment

Arrange safe, accessible choices so children can participate, repeat and restore with appropriate help. A center-wide curriculum does not mean infants and older children share unsafe materials or the same activity timetable.

Environment feature	Adult preparation
Relationships	Keep responsive familiar caregivers available. Plan calm handoffs and hear family information.
Movement and floor access	Provide clear safe space, stable positioning and mobility access. Do not force sitting, crawling, standing or a standard body position.
Materials	Inspect size, integrity, hygiene, sensory access and intended use. Keep small parts, sharp tools and older-child materials inaccessible to younger children.
Communication	Include home-language books, photos used with consent, signs, visuals and augmentative communication as appropriate.
Choice and quiet	Offer manageable choices and a route to a quieter or different experience without isolation or punishment.
Outdoor learning	Review weather, sun, air quality, boundaries, plants, surfaces and accessible movement options.
Work in progress	Preserve older children’s projects when practical. Photographs or work samples need consent and secure storage.

Use an approved safety review before introducing an unusual material, tool, food activity, water experience or experiment. The activity library is not permission to bypass care, supervision or individual plans.

Language, access and belonging

Include the child’s strongest communication and the languages used at home. A child may demonstrate understanding by gesture, drawing, movement, signs, a device, another language or supported action. English-only speech and eye contact are not participation requirements.

Plan adaptations before the invitation

Ask what sensory, movement, hearing, vision, communication and regulation access is needed. Offer a stable surface, alternate grip, visual sequence, extra processing time, quieter materials, a larger object or another way to respond. Adjust the challenge while preserving a meaningful purpose.

Represent families accurately

Use varied family structures, homes, abilities, languages, occupations and community experiences. Ask for a specific voluntary contribution rather than asking a family or child to represent an entire culture. Do not require photographs, religious disclosure, purchases, donations or public performance.

Respond to behavior as information

Describe the event, context and support. Stop harm, meet the immediate need and help children communicate or try a workable solution. Avoid character labels, public behavior rankings, forced apologies or withholding care. Do not ask children to negotiate unsafe treatment.

Keep professional decisions in the proper process

Curriculum observations can inform a conversation; they do not diagnose, replace validated screening or determine eligibility for support. Use the program’s approved family/referral and individualized-planning processes when a concern persists.

Care and safety anchors

Infants: responsive care and safe sleep

Use individual cues and approved care plans for feeding, rest, comfort and hygiene. Awake floor activity is separate from sleep. Tummy-time invitations are awake, directly supervised and adapted to comfort. Put infants on their backs for every sleep on the approved firm flat clear sleep surface, following current health procedures. No activity materials, loose cloth, toys or weighted items belong in the sleep space.

Every pathway

Adults check choking and mouthing risks, water, tools, allergies, heat, hygiene, outdoor conditions and individual access before an invitation. Direct supervision is essential for water, food preparation and tool activities. Empty water containers afterward and dry wet floors. Adults handle chemicals, hazardous spills, unknown plants, wildlife hazards and unsafe equipment.

Respect the child’s body and dignity

Do not force tasting, touch, eye contact, speech, a posture or an emotional performance. Support toileting with families and approved health practices; do not make toileting or disability-related independence a readiness test. Offer appropriate rest/quiet options and follow actual program/state procedures.

What this curriculum does not replace

Attendance, medication, feeding/health orders, illness, incident, safeguarding, emergency and legally required records stay in approved systems. Learning notes are not a substitute. This publication does not set staffing ratios or certify compliance with state/local rules.

Health-reference routes to verify before implementation are documented in the research log: AAP/HealthyChildren, CDC and Caring for Our Children. They could not be retrieved during authoring, so staff should review current authoritative guidance and local requirements.

Observe → plan → revisit

Step	Useful action	Record
Observe	Watch the actual event and receive family information.	What was seen/heard; context; date; access/support.
Interpret cautiously	Consider possibilities without turning a guess into a fact.	A working question, separate from the observation.
Plan	Choose a purpose and a few safe accessible invitations.	Why this invitation; materials; adaptation; actual child/group.
Join	Respond, model, ask, describe or step back.	Support actually given and the child’s response.
Review	Revisit evidence across time and contexts.	A possible next opportunity and what might change.

Useful note: “Matched one cup to each of five people, then counted after one reminder.” Less useful: “Mastered math.” Useful infant note: “Turned away after the third sound. Adult paused; infant relaxed and looked back.” Less useful: “Poor attention.”

The tool’s statuses describe interest, an offered invitation, exploration/practice, a strategy used independently in one observation, or a plan to adjust. They are not scores or permanent mastery labels. Independent performance is not an infant goal; responsive adult help is part of the learning environment.

Review learning across areas without turning coverage into a quota. A blank record is not a learning gap. A declined activity may indicate timing, access, preference or another need, and does not alone establish a developmental concern.

A workable staff planning rhythm

Before the day

Review family information and essential approved care plans; inspect the environment; choose a few possible invitations connected to actual observations. Keep familiar materials available and identify adaptations or supervision needs.

During the day

Protect responsive care, child-chosen play and useful conversation. One adult’s documentation should never reduce supervision. Short notes can be completed securely later. Record the factual event before writing an interpretation.

At the end of the day

Finish concise observations, restore materials and adjust the next invitation. Share a meaningful strength or event with families through the approved communication route. Record operational health/safety matters in their proper systems.

Weekly team review

Ask whose voice is missing, which support helped, which plan no longer fits, where evidence is thin and which family perspective would help. Choose a manageable next step instead of adding many activities. Export a secure backup of the local planning tool.

Initial implementation

Start with one or two familiar invitations per pathway, not the whole library. Practice factual note writing and review safety/access with trained staff. Use a brief pilot, family feedback and peer review before making center-wide changes. Confirm state standards and current reference guidance when access is available.

Young infants · Birth–5 months

Individual, cue-based interactions during care and brief comfortable awake play.

Adult rhythm: Notice cues → respond warmly → pause for a response → adjust or stop. Secure relationships and access to everyday experience; no academic drills or group-performance goals.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Build trust through a predictable response to an infant's communication. Support co-regulation through a familiar, responsive care sequence.	Notice a cue, answer, and pause (C001); A familiar calming sequence (C002)
Communication & early literacy	Experience a back-and-forth exchange without requiring speech or eye contact. Connect a familiar voice pattern with warm interaction.	Face-to-face conversation (C003); A family lullaby during care (C004)
Movement & self-care	Offer an accessible opportunity for active movement while awake. Explore voluntary reaching and midline movement.	Comfortable awake tummy-time invitation (C005); Reach toward a familiar hand (C006)
Thinking & mathematics	Notice a change and choose how to attend. Experience a simple social cause-and-effect pattern.	Following a slow nearby movement (C007); My response changes the exchange (C008)
Science & inquiry	Experience a gentle difference in the visual environment. Explore a comfortable sensory difference with adult support.	Noticing daylight and shade (C009); One safe texture at a time (C010)
Creative expression	Experience a simple rhythm through warm responsive interaction. Share visual interest and early meaning-making with a caregiver.	A gentle rhythmic exchange (C011); Sharing a high-contrast page (C012)
Community & belonging	Create a predictable connection during arrival. Connect classroom care with familiar people and home language.	A familiar welcome (C013); Family voices and photographs (C014)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Older infants · 6–11 months

Safe floor exploration with a nearby responsive adult; repeated familiar experiences.

Adult rhythm: Follow interest → offer a safe object/action → wait → acknowledge the child's response. Support emerging mobility and communication without forcing positions or milestones.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Support exploration while keeping connection available. Make care a cooperative interaction with a readable sequence.	Explore and return to a safe base (C015); Predictable care with a small pause (C016)
Communication & early literacy	Connect a word or sign with shared attention. Participate actively in a shared book experience.	Name what the child notices (C017); A book the child can help explore (C018)
Movement & self-care	Support the child's own way of moving toward an interest. Coordinate grasp, release and purposeful movement.	Travel toward a chosen object (C019); In and out with large objects (C020)
Thinking & mathematics	Explore whether a familiar object remains when partly hidden. Explore a simple action and its result.	A partly hidden familiar object (C021); A sound follows an action (C022)
Science & inquiry	Notice a sensory difference through voluntary exploration. Observe movement and what makes an object stop.	Compare two safe surfaces (C023); Watch a large ball travel (C024)
Creative expression	Express an idea and hear it acknowledged. Explore self-chosen movement in response to music.	Echo the child's sounds (C025); Move to a familiar song (C026)
Community & belonging	Communicate a preference that another person respects. Connect familiar people, names and warm conversation.	Choose between two familiar things (C027); Our familiar people book (C028)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Young toddlers · 12–23 months

Predictable routines, concrete materials, movement and short shared play.

Adult rhythm: Offer a choice → show one useful action → allow repetition → support a transition. Use real objects and home-language words; emerging skills need adult support.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Build predictability during separation and reunion. Connect an emotional experience with supportive language.	A supported arrival ritual (C029); Name a feeling and offer help (C030)
Communication & early literacy	Extend a child’s message through responsive language. Connect a repeated story with the child’s own communication.	A two-turn object conversation (C031); Retell a familiar page (C032)
Movement & self-care	Coordinate whole-body movement and stopping. Participate in a useful care routine with adult support.	Push, stop and park (C033); Help wipe a small safe spill (C034)
Thinking & mathematics	Explore capacity and the effects of adding and removing. Explore balance, arrangement and a change in structure.	Fill, empty and compare (C035); Build and change a short tower (C036)
Science & inquiry	Notice a real living thing or natural feature. Explore how a surface changes movement.	Look closely on a short nature visit (C037); A ramp for a large rolling object (C038)
Creative expression	Explore mark making through self-chosen movement. Choose and compare comfortable sound actions.	Big marks, real choices (C039); Quiet and lively sounds (C040)
Community & belonging	Participate in a predictable shared-space routine. Represent a familiar caring action without a required family script.	My place for familiar belongings (C041); Family routines in pretend play (C042)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Older toddlers · 24–35 months

Parallel play, pretend routines, simple problem solving and supported peer encounters.

Adult rhythm: Prepare two or more accessible choices → join briefly → model language → step back. Participation and regulation vary widely; no forced sharing or required sitting.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Practice being near a peer with responsive adult support. Participate in a transition with understandable support.	Two children, enough materials (C043); A supported transition choice (C044)
Communication & early literacy	Expand a meaningful message without taking over the play. Represent story events through action and communication.	Tell me about your play (C045); Act out a short familiar story (C046)
Movement & self-care	Plan a comfortable route using current movement abilities. Take an active part in a real hygiene sequence.	A safe movement pathway (C047); Handwashing as shared learning (C048)
Thinking & mathematics	Connect one count word with one object in a real task. Notice a shared feature and use a simple sorting rule.	Count a small useful collection (C049); Match and sort familiar objects (C050)
Science & inquiry	Make and observe a simple prediction with adult support. Explore how one change affects movement.	Sink or float: notice the result (C051); Change a rolling path (C052)
Creative expression	Choose a tool and explore its visual effect. Represent an idea through a self-chosen movement.	Paint with a chosen tool (C053); Echo and invent a movement (C054)
Community & belonging	Recognize varied homes and family experiences without ranking them. Participate in caring for a shared place.	Homes can look different (C055); Help care for our room (C056)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Preschool · 3 years · 36–47 months

Longer self-chosen center play with brief optional guided invitations and rich conversation.

Adult rhythm: Notice an idea → add a question or material → support a test or representation → revisit. Build concepts through play, movement, stories and relationships; avoid worksheets as the core.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Use a respectful entry strategy while honoring another person’s response. Practice explaining a need and trying a workable solution.	Ask to join and hear the answer (C057); Solve a small shared problem (C058)
Communication & early literacy	Build understanding and vocabulary through a shared story. Explore how spoken language and print carry useful meaning.	A question-rich read-aloud (C059); Names, sounds and useful signs (C060)
Movement & self-care	Coordinate hands to create an original construction. Coordinate movement while noticing other people and space.	Cut, arrange and join (C061); Move around a planned space (C062)
Thinking & mathematics	Use a small quantity to solve a real distribution problem. Explore shape properties through construction and explanation.	How many do we need? (C063); Build and describe a shape (C064)
Science & inquiry	Notice how position changes a shadow. Connect observation with a real care decision.	What makes a shadow change? (C065); A plant-care question (C066)
Creative expression	Communicate an idea through original choices. Use sound intentionally to represent an event or feeling.	Make art from an idea (C067); Sound patterns for a story (C068)
Community & belonging	Connect a shared agreement with safety, care and belonging. Explore one family’s experience respectfully.	Our classroom agreements in action (C069); Learn from a family contribution (C070)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Pre-K · 4 years · 48–59 months

Sustained play and projects with intentional small-group language, literacy and math.

Adult rhythm: Connect to experience → model a strategy → invite use → reflect with evidence. Offer explicit teaching within meaningful work; do not make a birthday a readiness rule.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Negotiate a shared idea while keeping participation flexible. Find a comfortable support with an adult during a manageable moment.	Plan roles for shared pretend play (C071); Try a helpful regulation strategy together (C072)
Communication & early literacy	Notice and manipulate spoken sounds through playful accessible interaction. Use drawing, emerging spelling, signs or dictation to communicate a purpose.	Hear and play with word sounds (C073); Make a meaningful message (C074)
Movement & self-care	Coordinate a useful preparation sequence with hygiene and access support. Plan, explain and adapt a movement game so others can join.	Prepare a safe shared snack task (C075); Design an accessible movement game (C076)
Thinking & mathematics	Use a counting or matching strategy to compare quantities. Recognize a repeated unit and use it to predict or create.	Count, compare and explain (C077); Continue and change a pattern (C078)
Science & inquiry	Compare the result of one changed condition. Use evidence to describe an animal’s features or behavior.	Test one change in a ramp (C079); Observe an animal without disturbing it (C080)
Creative expression	Use a design idea, notice a result and revise intentionally. Express a shared idea through chosen creative roles.	Create and revise a construction (C081); A child-authored performance choice (C082)
Community & belonging	Use a representation to communicate location and access. Plan and evaluate a contribution to a shared community.	Map a familiar place (C083); A real classroom helping project (C084)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Kindergarten bridge · 5- and 6-year-olds · 60–83 months

Play, purposeful projects and accessible explicit instruction, coordinated with the child’s school.

Adult rhythm: Choose a meaningful purpose → teach a needed tool → apply it → discuss and revise. Includes children through age six. This author-designed bridge is not a verified state kindergarten curriculum.

Learning area	Opportunities to support	Two starting invitations
Relationships & regulation	Coordinate ideas, roles and changing needs in a group project. Discuss a challenge using evidence and a useful support.	Collaborative planning with revision (C085); Reflect on a helpful next step (C086)
Communication & early literacy	Connect accessible decoding with the meaning of a real message. Use a source and an original message to communicate a finding.	Decode and understand a short message (C087); Research and write for a purpose (C088)
Movement & self-care	Coordinate a short meaningful sequence with accessible tools. Explore an upcoming routine without making independence a condition of belonging.	A multi-step practical project (C089); Practice a school-day routine through play (C090)
Thinking & mathematics	Explore an operation as a meaningful change in quantity. Choose and use a consistent comparison strategy.	Represent joining and separating (C091); Measure to solve a design problem (C092)
Science & inquiry	Compare conditions, record results and discuss the limits of a small test. Recognize that a representation shows some features and leaves out others.	A small fair-test investigation (C093); Compare a model with the real world (C094)
Creative expression	Sustain an idea, make choices and revise with authorship intact. Represent and communicate a pattern or expressive idea.	Develop an original work over time (C095); Compose a sound or movement sequence (C096)
Community & belonging	Use respectful inquiry before making a shared decision. Communicate strengths, interests and useful supports for a transition.	Listen to more than one perspective (C097); A family-informed transition portfolio (C098)

These are teaching possibilities, not expected achievements by the end of the age range. Notice comfort, choice, communication, access and support. Revisit simpler or more complex work when useful.

Daily flow: infants and toddlers

Infants — an individualized responsive cycle

Arrival and caregiver connection → respond to current feeding/rest/comfort needs → a brief awake interaction or safe floor exploration when available → care and recovery → repeat according to the actual child. Several children can be on different care rhythms. There is no required circle time, academic block or weekly-theme performance.

Toddlers — a predictable flexible flow

Part of the day	Learning opportunity
Arrival	A familiar handoff, comfort and an accessible choice.
Play and exploration	Concrete materials, movement, books and short responsive conversations. Repetition is welcome.
Outdoor movement	Accessible movement and safe close observation; adjust for weather and individual plans.
Care and food	Real participation with adult help; health, hygiene and feeding needs take priority.
Rest / quiet	Follow individual needs and actual program requirements; provide appropriate quiet alternatives.
Later play and departure	Return to familiar interests, restore together and share a factual family update.

A transition can carry learning through a word, gesture, useful action or predictable cue. Do not turn every care moment into a quiz or delay care to complete a teaching sequence.

Daily flow: preschool and kindergarten bridge

This is an example organization, not a required clock schedule. Adjust duration, meals, rest, outdoor access and transport to the actual program and children. Keep meaningful play and care central.

Example sequence	Purpose / adult role
Arrival and open choices	Welcome families, hear useful information, and support connection.
Sustained play / project period	Allow a substantial uninterrupted block when practical; offer brief individual or small-group invitations without rotating every child through the same task.
Outdoor movement and inquiry	Support active movement, access, observation and real questions.
Meal and care routines	Provide required care, conversation and appropriate participation.
Rest / quiet options	Respond to individual needs and actual program/state procedures.
Second play / investigation period	Revisit materials, a question, reading/writing purpose or a developing project.
Short shared reflection when useful	Children may show, tell, draw, point or choose not to perform.
Departure and family connection	Share a specific strength, event or useful support through approved routes.

For 5- and 6-year-olds, coordinate literacy, mathematics and transition supports with the receiving school. Explicit teaching can help a needed skill; worksheets and timed drills are not the foundation. This bridge has not been checked against a specific state kindergarten standard.

Flexible inquiry map · connections 1–2

1. Belonging and routines

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
1	Who is here and how do we connect?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
2	What helps us feel secure?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
3	How do we care for shared spaces?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
4	Which routines help, and what should change?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

2. Bodies, movement and care

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
5	What can our bodies do comfortably?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
6	How can we move through a space safely?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
7	What care and support do we need?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
8	How can we make movement accessible?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

Flexible inquiry map · connections 3–4

3. People, families and communication

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
9	How do people communicate?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
10	What matters in different families?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
11	How can we ask, listen and respond?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
12	What have we learned from another perspective?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

4. Light, shadow and sound

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
13	What do we notice about light?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
14	How can a position change a shadow?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
15	What makes a sound, and who can access it?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
16	How can we represent a noticed change?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

Flexible inquiry map · connections 5–6

5. Water, weather and change

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
17	What changes can we observe?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
18	What happens when we test a safe idea?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
19	What does the weather mean for our care?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
20	What evidence have we recorded?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

6. Living things

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
21	What do living things need?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
22	What can we observe without harming?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
23	How do we care for a plant or place?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
24	What has changed over time?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

Flexible inquiry map · connections 7–8

7. Materials and making

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
25	What can this material do?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
26	Which tool helps us act on an idea?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
27	What happens when we change one feature?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
28	What would we keep or revise?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

8. Buildings and journeys

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
29	How do people and things move?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
30	What makes a structure useful?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
31	How can we describe a route?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
32	Who can use what we have designed?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

Flexible inquiry map · connections 9–10

9. Patterns, shapes and quantities

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
33	What repeats or fits together?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
34	How can we compare?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
35	How many or how much is useful here?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
36	How can we explain our strategy?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

10. Stories, signs and messages

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
37	What story do we want to tell?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
38	How do words and symbols carry meaning?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
39	Who is our audience?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
40	Does our message say what we intended?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

Flexible inquiry map · connections 11–12

11. Food, gardens and community

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
41	How do people care for a shared need?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
42	What can we prepare or grow safely?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
43	How do choices reflect different families?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
44	Did our contribution help?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

12. Reflection and transitions

Slot	Question / connection	Planning move
45	What have we returned to?	Notice interests and access; choose a few useful invitations.
46	What work matters to the child?	Revisit familiar work and model one useful strategy.
47	Which supports should travel with us?	Extend one child-led question or comparison when ready.
48	What question or invitation comes next?	Review actual evidence with children/families and plan a next opportunity.

Infant/toddler use: Keep responsive care and familiar routines stable. Use this connection only if a real infant/toddler interest makes it meaningful; no weekly theme performance is expected.

Families, review and transitions

A useful conversation

Begin with a specific strength and invite the family’s account. Explain the context and actual support rather than a global label. Ask what the child enjoys, which language or routine is helpful and what priority the family wants heard. An optional home connection should use safe ordinary routines and never require a purchase, project or public disclosure.

When there is a concern

Document repeated observations and access/support already tried, separate from interpretation. Talk with the family through the program’s approved process and seek qualified guidance as appropriate. Do not diagnose from a lesson, wait for completion of the curriculum before raising a concern, or present a curriculum status as a screening result.

A strengths-based transition handoff

With authorization, share the child’s interests, meaningful work samples, communication strengths, useful supports and the family’s perspective. Include the child’s voice in an accessible form. Keep attendance, health, individual service plans and legally required transfers in their approved systems.

Privacy

Use only necessary teaching information. Keep names, photographs, quotations and backups private. The included browser tool stores locally without shared staff accounts, cloud synchronization or application-level encryption. A real multiuser deployment needs separate access, storage, retention and consent decisions.

Reference review and next checks

All ten online retrievals failed with proxy CONNECT 403 errors. An escalated read-only government-site request also failed. No returned source body was read. The following routes identify what should be reviewed; they are not citations to a completed live review.

Reference	Purpose / status
Curriculum prevalence search — Search engine	Current nationwide popularity ranking Not retrieved. https://www.google.com/search?q=most+widely+used+preschool+curriculum+United+States+Creative+Curriculum+HighScope+Head+Start+FACES
Head Start curriculum consumer reports — U.S. Department of Health and Human Services	Program-specific curriculum review framework; not national market share Not retrieved. https://headstart.gov/curriculum
Head Start Early Learning Outcomes Framework — U.S. Department of Health and Human Services	Birth-to-five learning framework reference route Not retrieved. https://headstart.gov/school-readiness/article/head-start-early-learning-outcomes-framework
Developmentally Appropriate Practice — NAEYC	Developmentally appropriate teaching reference route Not retrieved. https://www.naeyc.org/resources/position-statements/dap/contents
The Creative Curriculum — Teaching Strategies	Recognized commercial whole-child curriculum; any popularity claim would be publisher-reported unless independently supported Not retrieved. https://teachingstrategies.com/product/the-creative-curriculum/
HighScope approach — HighScope Educational Research Foundation	Active participatory learning reference route Not retrieved. https://highscope.org/our-practice/
Frog Street curriculum — Frog Street	Recognized commercial curriculum family; no verified market-share comparison Not retrieved. https://www.frogstreet.com/
Developmental milestones — CDC	Family developmental monitoring; not a curriculum test or diagnosis Not retrieved. https://www.cdc.gov/act-early/milestones/index.html
Safe sleep information — American Academy of Pediatrics / HealthyChildren	Infant safe-sleep reference route; local health policies still apply Not retrieved. https://www.healthychildren.org/English/ages-stages/baby/sleep/Pages/A-Parents-Guide-to-Safe-Sleep.aspx
Caring for Our Children — National Resource Center for Health and Safety in Child Care and Early Education	Health and safety reference route Not retrieved. https://nrckids.org/CFOC

Before formal implementation: review current sources, applicable state early-learning/kindergarten standards, current health guidance, individualized plans and the program’s requirements. Review bilingual/communication access, activity safety and classroom usability with qualified staff and families. No national market-share ranking, official endorsement or completed standards validation is claimed.